The examination is being carried out on the **following application documents**

Description, Pages

1-269 as published

Claims, Numbers

1-15 filed with entry into the regional phase before the EPO

Drawings, Sheets

1/147-147/147 as published

Reference is made to the following documents; the numbering will be adhered to in the rest of the procedure.

D1 US 2018/293809 A1 (JAMES MICHAEL R [US] ET AL) 11 October 2018 (2018-10-11)

D2 US 2011/196571 A1 (FOLADARE MARK J [US] ET AL) 11 August 2011 (2011-08-11)

D3 US 2004/267410 A1 (DURI SASTRY S [US] ET AL) 30 December 2004 (2004-12-30)

1 With regard to present claim 1 the document D1 discloses an apparatus comprising: a policy acquisition circuit structured to interpret a vehicle policy data value comprising a location description value (paragraph 0019);
a policy processing circuit structured to generate, in response to and based at least in part on the vehicle policy data value, parsed policy data that comprises a vehicle data collection description (paragraph 0025); and
a policy execution circuit structured to:
collect vehicle data from one or more end points of at least one ~~network zone~~ of a vehicle in response to the parsed policy data (paragraph 0025); and
adjust the collection of vehicle data in response to the location description value (paragraph 0030).

The named circuits are only described in form of their function and are therefore not considered to be limiting above and beyond their respective functionalities. This is also the reason why claims 12-15 are considered to fulfil the requirements of Article 123(2) EPC.

The difference between the apparatus of claim 1 and that of D1 is therefore that the communication network of the vehicle is partitioned into zones. This is not considered as inventive for two reasons: It is well known in the area to partition vehicle networks into zones and even if it would not be considered well known it would not give raise to a technical effect in the context of the claim.

Hence claim 1 does not fulfil the requirements of Article 56 EPC since its subject matter does not involve an inventive step.

2 Independent claim 12 is only the method equivalent of claim 1 and therefore the above objection regarding inventive step of claim 1 also holds for claim 12.

Hence claim 12 does not fulfil the requirements of Article 56 EPC since its subject matter does not involve an inventive step.

3 The additional subject matter of claim 2 is known from paragraph 0030 of D1. The additional subject matter of claims 3, 4, 13 and 14 are known from paragraph 0041-0043. The additional subject matter of claim 5 is considered obvious. It is well known in the area to format data to improve efficiency. The additional subject matter of claim 6 is known from paragraph 0030 of D1. The additional subject matter of claim 7 is known from paragraph 0022 of D1. The additional subject matter of claims 8-11 and 15 is considered obvious, since it is well known in the area to prioritise some data if there is a shortage of for instance storage space or bandwidth.

4 Hence claim 2-11 and 13-15 do not fulfil the requirements of Article 56 EPC since their subject matter does not involve an inventive step.

5 The independent claims are not in the two-part form, which in the present case would be appropriate, with those features known from the prior art being placed in the preamble and with the remaining features being included in the characterising part (Rule 43(b) EPC).

6 To meet the requirements of Rule 42(b) EPC, the documents D1-D3 should have been identified in the description and the relevant background art disclosed therein should have been briefly discussed.

7 The features of the claims should have been provided with reference signs placed in parentheses to increase the intelligibility of the claims (Rule 43(7) EPC). This applies to both the preamble and characterising portion.

8 When filing amended claims the applicant should at the same time bring the description into conformity with the amended claims. Care should be taken during revision, especially of the introductory portion and any statements of problem or advantage, not to add subject-matter which extends beyond the content of the application as originally filed (Article 123(2) EPC).

In order to facilitate the examination of the conformity of the amended application with the requirements of Article 123(2) EPC, the applicant is requested to clearly identify the amendments carried out, irrespective of whether they concern amendments by addition, replacement or deletion, and to indicate the passages of the application as filed on which these amendments are based.

If the applicant regards it as appropriate these indications could be submitted in handwritten form on a copy of the relevant parts of the application as filed.